

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

NEW STATE RECORD ☐

UNUSUAL RECORD ☒

CFO-ORC FILE # 1998-6
ACCEPTED 7-0
✓ rec'd 9-28-98

Species: Little Blue Heron (*Egretta tricolor*)

Date: 1 August 1998

Number seen: one

Sex: ?

Plumage: Juvenal

Locality: un-named pond, ½ mi. SSE Lochbuie

Elevation: about 5000'

Nearest town: Lochbuie

County: Adams (just 300 meters south of Weld)

Time observed: early afternoon

Duration of observation: about 1 minute

Description: While conducting a Big Day, I found a juvenile Little Blue Heron, which my teammates Chris Wood and Brandon Percival also got to see. It was a white heron with a Snowy Egret nearby. It was slightly bigger than the egret with a stouter, bicolored (grayish and dark) bill. It was standing in fairly deep water, thus only a small portion of its legs were visible. The portion of the legs that was visible was greenish. The bare loreal skin was bluish-gray and the eyes were yellowish. I did not discern whether the bird had dark primary tips. The bird foraged very sedately, not like the often frenetic foraging style of Snowy Egret.

I did not see the bird after this date, despite its continued presence reported by other observers. There were numerous juvenile Snowy Egrets (2-12) present at this site in the first half of August, however.

Similar species eliminated: The only real confusion species is Snowy Egret which can be exceedingly similar. This bird had the typical bill shape and pattern of a juvenile Little Blue Heron. Juvenile Snowy Egrets have more completely dark bills and usually show at least a trace of the adult yellow lores. Leg color can be identical in recently-fledged individuals of the two species.

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration): No vocalizations heard.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly-appearing species? I have seen 1000s of Little Blues and Snowy Egrets across the country.

Light conditions: sun overhead

Optical equipment used: Kowa 30x

Distance, and how estimated: estimated at about 200 meters

Other observers who saw the bird with you: Chris Wood and Brandon Percival

Other observers who saw the bird independently: I am unsure of this item.

If photographed, type of equipment and film: I did not photograph.

List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification:

a) at time of observation: none

b) after observation: none

Reporting observer: Tony Leukering

Signature:



Address: Colorado Bird Observatory, 13401 Piccadilly Road, Brighton, CO 80601

Date report was written: I wrote this from memory on 20 September 1998.